

INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

THIS WEEK NAR VOTED DOWN A RULE THAT WOULD'VE REQUIRED AGENTS TO ADMIT WHEN A NEIGHBORHOOD ISN'T THEIR SPECIALTY.

Their reason why is exactly backwards.

D.J. Paris

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**ONE ARGUMENT
AGAINST THE RULE:
ADMITTING A
KNOWLEDGE GAP
WOULD MAKE A
CLIENT LOSE TRUST
IN YOU.**

That's backwards, and the best agents already know it.

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NAR'S OWN PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS COMMITTEE PROPOSED IT AT THE MIDYEAR MEETINGS IN D.C.

The committee chair called it an ethical duty. The Executive Committee sent it back.

"ADMITTING YOU DON'T KNOW SOMETHING WOULD MAKE A CLIENT LOSE TRUST IN YOU."

That was one of the stated reasons
for rejecting the rule.

IN TWELVE YEARS INTERVIEWING TOP PRODUCERS, I'VE NEVER MET ONE WHO PRETENDED TO KNOW EVERY MARKET IN THE CITY.

Chicago is fifty different markets. A Lincoln Park condo expert has no business winging a land deal in the south suburbs.

**MOST AGENTS THINK
ADMITTING A GAP LOSES THE
DEAL. THE BEST ONES KNOW
IT'S WHAT EARNS THE CLIENT
FOR LIFE.**

THE MOVE, NEXT TIME YOU DON'T KNOW THE AREA:

- 1** Say so, out loud, to the client.
- 2** Refer it to someone who does.
- 3** You lose one commission.
- 4** You gain a referral source for the next ten years.

THE TAKEAWAY

**NEXT LEAD THAT
LANDS SOMEWHERE
YOU DON'T KNOW
COLD, SAY SO AND
MAKE THE REFERRAL
BEFORE YOU TALK
YOURSELF INTO
WINGING IT.**

You don't need a rule to be honest. The best agents never needed NAR to make it mandatory.

D.J. Paris

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